

ALTAR CURATED

Website Design + Development Brief

Project: Altar Curated V1 Website

Website Type: E-commerce + Editorial + Digital Product Ecosystem

Launch Architecture: Shop + The Greenhouse + The Apothecary

Launch Catalogue: 5 carefully selected products

Key Launch Product: *Reflections in Bloom*

01 — BRAND / DIGITAL VISION

Altar Curated is **not intended to function as a conventional e-commerce storefront**.

The website should feel like entering an **immersive digital world** — a contemporary spiritual/editorial space where products, writing, rituals, education, creativity and community naturally connect.

The experience should sit somewhere between:

- an independent editorial publication
- a digital apothecary
- a personal spiritual library
- an art-directed lifestyle brand
- an online shop
- an interactive botanical estate

The website should feel **curated, intimate, intelligent, mystical and editorial** rather than overtly “woo-woo” or like a generic spirituality marketplace.

Core principle

Build the house now, even if every room isn’t furnished on day one.

The V1 website should be relatively focused, but the underlying architecture must allow Altar Curated to expand without requiring a complete rebuild.

02 — THE THREE PILLARS

I. THE SHOP

The commercial centre of Altar Curated.

Initial categories:

- Journals
- Digital products
- Decks / cards
- Apothecary
- Ritual objects

The shop should not feel like a catalogue disconnected from the rest of the website.

Products should appear naturally throughout the wider ecosystem.

For example:

Article → ritual → journal prompt → product → email signup

rather than simply:

Product → Add to Cart

II. THE GREENHOUSE

The Greenhouse is the **editorial and discovery world** of Altar Curated.

It should feel like an ever-growing digital garden/archive.

Content ecosystem

- Journal
- Rituals
- Seasonal living
- Botanical world
- Guides
- Reflections
- Journal prompts
- Educational resources
- Recommendations
- Botanical stories

The Greenhouse should be architected as an **expandable content world**, rather than simply another Shopify collection.

Desired user journey

Discover



Read / Explore



Reflect



Save / Subscribe



Explore a related product



Enter another part of Altar

Example

Article:

Creating a Grounding Evening Ritual



Related products:

Candle + Journal + Crystal



Related journal prompts



Newsletter signup



Apothecary

This content-to-product relationship is a fundamental part of the Altar Curated ecosystem.

III. THE APOTHECARY

The Apothecary should feel like a **curated ritual and sensory world**, not simply a product category.

Potential architecture:

THE APOTHECARY

- Candles
- Crystals
- Ritual objects
- Botanical goods
- Sensory objects
- Curated tools

The experience should connect:

SHOP → LEARN → RITUAL

The goal is for someone to understand **how and why an object fits into their practice**, rather than simply purchasing an object.

03 — THE ALTAR “WORLD” CONCEPT

The homepage should explore an **illustrated botanical-estate / digital-world approach** rather than a conventional hero-image e-commerce homepage.

Think:

An Altar Curated estate that visitors can explore.

Potential visual spaces:

THE ALTAR

The central entry point / brand identity.

THE APOTHECARY

Shopping, ritual objects and physical products.

THE CONSERVATORY

Reflections in Bloom and publishing.

THE GREENHOUSE

Community, seasonal living, rituals and editorial content.

THE LIBRARY

Writing, essays, journal/archive.

THE STUDIO

Creative process, YouTube and behind-the-scenes content.

THE OBSERVATORY

Interactive experiences, quizzes, explorations and future mystery/discovery elements.

This should **not** become a technically heavy 3D/WebGL website.

Preferred direction:

Beautiful illustrated environment + interactive hotspots + subtle movement + excellent usability.

The illustration should be atmospheric enough to create a world while remaining accessible and fast.

04 — HOMEPAGE EXPERIENCE

The homepage should immediately communicate:

This is a world you can enter.

Recommended flow

1. Opening / Estate

A visually distinctive illustrated environment.

Primary navigation remains immediately accessible.

2. Enter Altar

Short brand introduction.

Minimal copy.

Focus on atmosphere and curiosity.

3. Explore the World

Interactive / visual pathways into:

- Shop
 - Greenhouse
 - Apothecary
 - Reflections in Bloom
 - Journal
 - Future experiences
-

4. Featured Product / Reflections in Bloom

A strong editorial presentation of the launch product.

5. The Greenhouse

Featured article / ritual / seasonal piece.

6. Apothecary

Featured curated objects or collection.

7. Editorial / Journal

Recent writing, reflections or guides.

8. Newsletter / Community

A visually distinctive invitation to enter the Altar ecosystem.

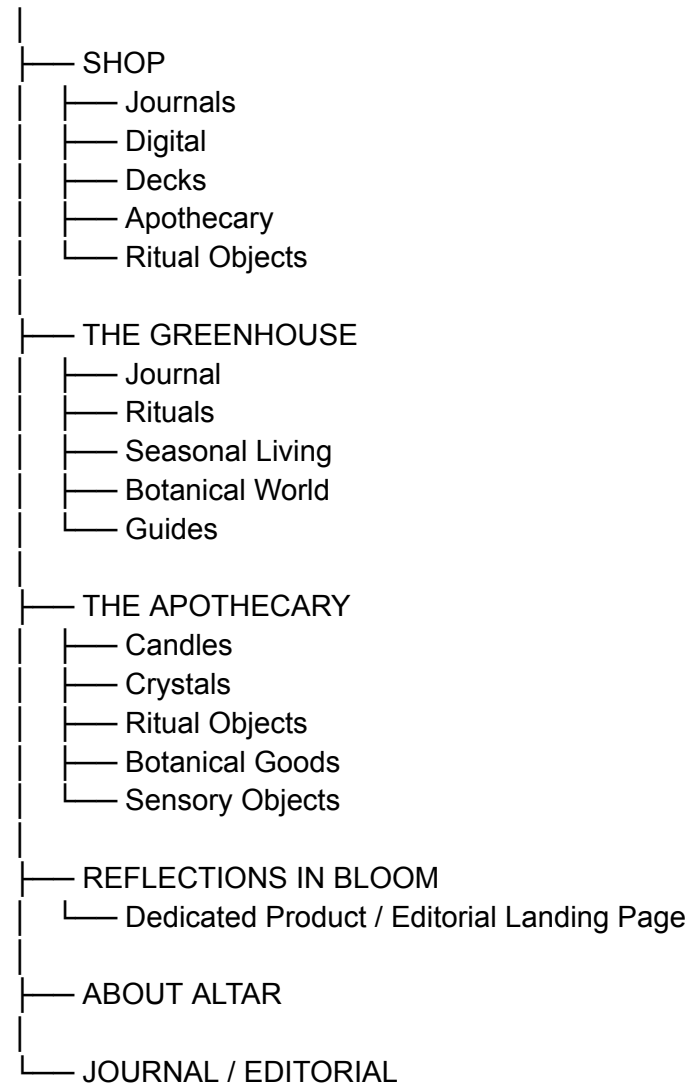
9. Footer

- Shop

- Greenhouse
 - Apothecary
 - About
 - Journal
 - Contact
 - Shipping
 - Returns
 - Privacy
 - Terms
 - Socials
-

05 — SITE ARCHITECTURE

ALTAR CURATED



The exact naming can evolve during UX development, but the underlying architecture should remain expandable.

06 — REFLECTIONS IN BLOOM

Reflections in Bloom should receive a **dedicated, editorially designed product experience** rather than being treated like a standard product listing.

Page should communicate

- What the journal is
- Why it exists
- Its philosophy
- Interior / product imagery
- Selected spreads
- What is inside
- How to use it
- Who it is for
- Related Altar products
- Newsletter / community entry point

Potential ecosystem:

Reflections in Bloom



Journal prompts



Greenhouse content



Related rituals



Apothecary products



Email / community

The website should be ready to receive traffic from the book/product launch and direct that audience into the wider Altar ecosystem.

07 — “MY ALTAR”

Introduce a personal account / profile experience that can eventually become:

MY ALTAR

Potential future functionality:

- Saved products
- Saved Greenhouse articles
- Wishlist
- Digital purchases
- Personal recommendations
- Previous orders
- Personalised content
- Future “personal altar” experiences

For V1, keep the functionality appropriately lightweight while establishing the account architecture for future expansion.

08 — PRODUCT PAGE EXPERIENCE

Product pages should feel editorial rather than transactional.

Required structure

Product name

Short poetic / editorial descriptor

Product imagery

Story / philosophy

What it is

How to use it

Details / specifications

Shipping information

Related ritual / Greenhouse content

Related products

Reviews

Add to cart

Product ecosystem

Every relevant product should have opportunities to connect to:

- Greenhouse articles
 - Rituals
 - Journal prompts
 - Other products
 - Email/community
-

09 — DIGITAL PRODUCTS

The architecture must support both physical and digital products.

Potential digital ecosystem:

- Digital journals
- E-guides
- Prompt bundles
- Printable resources
- Downloads
- Future courses
- Future workshops

Digital products should have a seamless:

Purchase → Payment → Delivery → Account

experience.

10 — VISUAL DIRECTION

Overall aesthetic

Desired keywords

Botanical

Mystical

Editorial

Warm

Artistic

Intimate

Literary

Curated

Tactile

Contemporary

Slightly strange / intriguing

Nostalgic without feeling vintage

Avoid

- Generic “spirituality shop” aesthetics
- Excessive celestial motifs
- Overuse of moons/stars/crystals
- Generic beige wellness branding
- Stock photography
- Overly feminine “witchy” clichés
- Template-like Shopify layouts
- Excessive gradients
- Overly polished luxury-brand sterility

The objective is:

A world, not an Etsy storefront.

11 — COLOUR SYSTEM

Primary palette

ALTAR BROWN

#3B241C

Deep chocolate / dark earth.

Use for:

- Primary backgrounds
 - Navigation
 - Footer
 - Typography on light surfaces
 - Major visual anchors
-

BOTANICAL LIME

#B7D83D

Unexpected, energetic botanical green.

Use selectively for:

- CTAs
- Hover states
- Small graphic details
- Interactive elements
- Highlights
- Navigation indicators

This should be an **accent**, not the dominant background.

MYSTIC LAVENDER

#B9A6D8

Soft mystical purple.

Use for:

- Secondary backgrounds
 - Editorial sections
 - Digital-product moments
 - Illustration details
 - Seasonal content
-

Supporting neutrals

WARM PAPER

#F4EBDD

A warm parchment / natural paper tone.

SOFT SAGE

#A8B29A

Muted botanical green for secondary visual areas.

INK

#191513

Near-black for high-contrast editorial typography.

PALETTE BALANCE

60% — Warm Paper / Neutral

25% — Chocolate Brown

10% — Botanical Green

5% — Lavender + experimental accents

The overall experience should remain warm and earthy, with the lime and lavender acting as moments of surprise.

12 — TYPOGRAPHY

The typography should create a **literary-editorial contrast**.

Recommended system

Display / Headlines

Editorial serif with distinctive character.

Possible references:

- Cormorant Garamond
- DM Serif Display
- Fraunces

- Playfair Display
- Instrument Serif

Body

Clean contemporary sans-serif.

Possible references:

- Inter
- Manrope
- DM Sans
- Satoshi
- Neue Montreal

Typography principle

Serif = world / story / emotion

Sans-serif = navigation / information / commerce

Avoid overly ornate typography.

13 — PHOTOGRAPHY

Photography should feel:

- tactile
- intimate
- editorial
- slightly imperfect
- naturally lit
- warm
- atmospheric

Product photography

Prioritise:

- Texture
- Materials
- Hands
- Pages
- Objects in environments
- Close crops
- Natural shadows

- Botanical elements
- Lived-in compositions

Avoid generic white-background product photography as the only visual language.

Use clean product shots where necessary for commerce, but balance them with **world-building imagery**.

14 — ILLUSTRATION

Illustration is a major opportunity for Altar Curated.

Desired direction:

- Botanical linework
- Vintage scientific illustration influences
- Hand-drawn details
- Architectural diagrams
- Estate maps
- Plants
- Objects
- Small symbolic motifs
- Illustrated rooms
- Marginalia
- Handwritten annotations

The visual language should feel like **an old illustrated botanical book translated into a contemporary digital world**.

15 — INTERACTION / MOTION

Motion should be subtle and purposeful.

Desired

- Gentle hover animations
- Botanical movement
- Soft page transitions
- Interactive hotspots
- Small illustrated details appearing on interaction
- Scroll-based reveals
- Subtle parallax where performance allows

Avoid

- Heavy WebGL
- Long loading animations
- Excessive cursor effects
- Distracting transitions
- Animation that interferes with shopping/navigation

Performance and usability always take priority over novelty.

16 — NAVIGATION

Navigation should remain intuitive even within the immersive concept.

Primary

SHOP | GREENHOUSE | APOTHECARY | ABOUT

Secondary / utility:

SEARCH | MY ALTAR | CART

Potential persistent CTA:

ENTER THE GREENHOUSE

or

EXPLORE ALTAR

Mobile navigation should be particularly clean.

17 — MOBILE-FIRST

The website must be designed **mobile-first**.

Required mobile UX:

- Homepage
- Navigation
- Product page
- Cart
- Checkout

- Digital-product purchase
- Newsletter signup
- Greenhouse article
- Apothecary
- Account / My Altar

Instagram and social content will be major discovery channels, making mobile landing-page performance particularly important.

18 — MARKETING + CONTENT ECOSYSTEM

The website should function as the **conversion centre of Altar Curated's content ecosystem**.

Example funnel

Instagram Reel



Greenhouse article



Email signup



Free journal prompt / resource



Reflections in Bloom



Related product



Repeat purchase

Alternative funnel

Instagram



Apothecary



Product



Ritual guide



Email



Future purchase

The website should therefore be designed around **customer journeys**, not isolated pages.

19 — EMAIL / COMMUNITY INFRASTRUCTURE

The website should support:

- Newsletter signup
- Welcome sequence
- Abandoned-cart emails
- Post-purchase emails
- Product recommendations
- Book/product launch sequences
- Seasonal campaigns
- New collection announcements
- Digital-product delivery
- Customer segmentation

Potential audience segments:

- Journal buyers
- Digital-product buyers

- Apothecary customers
 - Deck customers
 - Newsletter-only audience
 - Repeat customers
-

20 — SEO / DISCOVERABILITY

SEO should be integrated into the website architecture from the beginning.

Required

- Keyword architecture
- Metadata
- SEO-friendly URLs
- Image alt text
- Structured data / schema
- Internal linking
- Product SEO
- Editorial SEO
- Search Console
- Analytics

Strategic priority

The Greenhouse should eventually function as Altar Curated's **organic discovery engine**.

Editorial content should therefore be designed to connect search → education → product → community.

21 — E-COMMERCE FUNCTIONALITY

V1 should support:

- Product catalogue
- Collections
- Product variants
- Cart
- Checkout
- Payment gateway
- Shipping
- Customer accounts

- Reviews
- Search
- Filtering
- Coupons / discounts
- Digital-product delivery
- Email capture
- Order confirmation
- Mobile optimisation

Preferred platform direction discussed previously:

Shopify

with an India-friendly payment setup and integrations appropriate to the final technical stack.

22 — ANALYTICS

Track the full customer journey:

Social → Website → Product → Cart → Checkout → Purchase

Minimum tracking:

- Traffic
 - Traffic source
 - Instagram → website clicks
 - Product views
 - Add-to-cart
 - Checkout initiated
 - Conversion rate
 - Average order value
 - Repeat customers
 - Email signups
 - Digital-product sales
 - Best-performing content
 - Best-performing products
-

23 — REFERENCE WEBSITES

These are **creative / strategic references**, not templates to replicate.

Saka Essentials

sakaessentials.com

Reference for:

Sanctuary-like brand experience, editorial commerce, community, storytelling and integrating products into a larger world.

Web Altar

web-altar.xyz

Reference for:

Interactive altar concept, participatory digital experience and unusual web-world thinking.

Speck of Rot

[Speck of Rot / Substack](#)

Reference for:

Editorial identity, writing-led digital presence and unconventional visual language.

We're Not Really Strangers

[We're Not Really Strangers](#)

Reference for:

Emotional storytelling, interactive/community-oriented brand experience and turning a product into a larger cultural world.

Princess Ri

[Princess Ri](#)

Reference for:

Personal-world building, personality-driven visual identity and unconventional web presentation.

House of Heaven

[House of Heaven / Substack](#)

Reference for:

Mystical/editorial atmosphere and writing-led spiritual content.

Otherwise Academy

[Otherwise Academy](#)

Reference for:

Educational ecosystem and content-led digital architecture.

Tam Kaur

[Tam Kaur — Productivity Journal](#)

Reference for:

Digital creator → product → personal brand ecosystem and journal product presentation.

Butteir

[Butteir](#)

Reference for:

Visual direction, product presentation and contemporary lifestyle branding.

Statement Gaia

[Statement Gaia](#)

Reference for:

Experimental digital presentation and immersive visual identity.

Starbeary Jewels

[Starbeary Jewels](#)

Reference for:

Distinctive product-world building and playful visual commerce.

Rerunn

[Rerunn](#)

Reference for:

E-commerce presentation and product discovery.

Eossa

[Eossa](#)

Reference for:

Indian contemporary brand / e-commerce visual language.

These references are drawn from the existing Altar Curated website/ecosystem brief.

24 — CREATIVE NORTH STAR

The website should sit at the intersection of:

BOTANICAL WORLD

×

DIGITAL ALTAR

×

EDITORIAL PUBLICATION

×

APOTHECARY

×

E-COMMERCE

×

COMMUNITY

The visitor should not feel like they have simply arrived at an online store.

They should feel like they have **entered Altar Curated**.

25 — V1 SUCCESS CRITERIA

The V1 website should:

BRAND

Feel unmistakably like Altar Curated.

EXPERIENCE

Create a sense of discovery without sacrificing usability.

COMMERCE

Make purchasing simple and trustworthy.

CONTENT

Make the Greenhouse a genuine destination.

ECOSYSTEM

Connect content, products, publishing and community.

SCALABILITY

Allow additional products, editorial categories, digital products and interactive experiences to be added without rebuilding the foundation.

PERFORMANCE

Remain fast, responsive and mobile-first.

CONVERSION

Create clear journeys from discovery → engagement → email → purchase → repeat engagement.

26 — FINAL CREATIVE DIRECTION

Do not build a spiritual Shopify store.

Build a **digital botanical estate** that happens to contain a shop.

The Shop is where people **buy**.

The Greenhouse is where people **discover**.

The Apothecary is where people **ritualise**.

Reflections in Bloom is where people **begin reflecting**.

The Journal is where people **stay connected**.

And **My Altar** can eventually become where people build their own relationship with the world.

ALTAR CURATED = A WORLD, NOT A CATALOGUE.